



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas School
School Website: <https://veritasschool.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas School, Newberg, Oregon (97132) presents itself as a robust Classical Christian school. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered mission, formation of virtue and wisdom, and a Trivium-based curriculum that foregrounds liberal arts, Great Books, and a memory-rich pedagogy in the lower grades. The school repeatedly anchors its identity to formation (wisdom, virtue, Godliness) rather than mere information, and it ties curriculum and pedagogy to a long-standing classical tradition (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; The Lost Tools of Learning). These themes align strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework for a classical education.

Overall, the six categories consistently demonstrate Classical alignment, with explicit religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purpose, a Trivium-based curriculum centered on liberal arts and Great Books, a pedagogy that blends rote/memory-rich practice with Socratic-style inquiry in upper grades, and clearly defined teacher and parent/community roles. The aggregate assessment is **CLASSICAL**.

Key takeaways: - Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit (Christ-centered, Statement of Faith, God-focused language). - Purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as real. - Curriculum centers on the Trivium, Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, and the Great Conversation. - Pedagogy combines lower-school chanting/memory with upper-school discussion and rhetoric—consistent with classical practice. - Faculty are described as experienced and mission-driven; public statements frame teachers as living curriculum. - Parent/community partnership is foregrounded (events, family resources, welcoming of visits).

Evidence is drawn from Veritas School materials in the crawl content (e.g., The Classical Difference and The Trivium Model; Portrait of a Graduate; Cultivating Wisdom, Virtue & Godliness) and from the knowledge-base keywords for classical education (positive/negative keyword indicators such as wisdom, virtue, truth, beauty, Great Books, Socratic dialogue, and formation) to ground the assessment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered mission and theological grounding (e.g., “the mission of Veritas School is to provide a classical, Christ-centered education that cultivates wisdom, virtue, and godliness” and references to God/Christ in the Portrait of a Graduate). - The school’s statements reference theology through the Statement of Faith and a Christ-centered focus in events and messaging. - Language on the site asserts a sacred, sacred-tradition orientation (e.g., “the Bible teaches... beauty,” and the link between art, beauty, and faith).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, God, Jesus Christ, theology/statement of faith, sacred tradition, spiritual depth, virtue, wisdom, godliness, true/good/beautiful expressions of truth and beauty. (anchored by the explicit Christ-centered framing and the Portrait of a Graduate language) - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials (no explicit secular ethics or non-theistic framing). The public materials consistently tie education to religious formation.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate transcendental aims and theological grounding, with communal liturgical-like and worship-leaning language through faith integration and Statement of Faith references, which is consistent with Classical/Christian foundational norms. The positive indicators overwhelmingly outweigh any neutral/negative signals. Hence CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school declares its purpose as “to provide a classical, Christ-centered education that cultivates wisdom, virtue, and godliness” (formation of character and intellect over mere information). - Foundational materials emphasize formation (virtue, wisdom, Godliness) rather than purely utilitarian outcomes; Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes discernment, persuasive communication, service, and virtuous behavior aligned with Scripture. - The public messaging asserts truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable (pivotal transcendental aims) and that mind-formation occurs through a classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: wisdom, virtue, godliness, formation, truth/goodness/beauty, classical, great conversation (as part of the Great Books ethos). - Negative keywords: none in public messaging (no emphasis on job-readiness as sole goal; the messaging centers formation/wisdom, not mere credentials).

Why this rating - Clear formation-oriented aims rooted in virtue and transcendentals; a classical hierarchy of aims (truth/goodness/beauty) and a formation-first philosophy. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Seven Liberal Arts, with an updated Trivium model described as the organizing framework for all subjects. - Great Books and Great Conversation are explicitly invoked (the school links to classical resources and references to Great Books; “a love of books, particularly The Great Books” is noted for secondary students). - The school emphasizes a liberal-arts approach to education and a memory-oriented grammar stage with chanting and singing as a foundational pedagogy (lower grades), and a progression into logic and rhetoric in later years. - The Veritas materials reference The Lost Tools of Learning and The Four Foundations of Great Teaching as guides for pedagogy and curriculum alignment.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium, Seven Liberal Arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, memory/recitation, formation through liberal arts, The Lost Tools of Learning, Great Teaching foundations. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials; no references to “workforce preparation” or other non-classicalCurriculum misalignments in the public-facing content.

Why this rating - The curriculum aligns with classic classical education design: the Trivium, liberal arts, Great Books, and a deliberate pedagogy that moves from memory-based grammar to logic to rhetoric; the explicit mention of Great Books and Great Conversation supports the CLASSICAL designation. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades emphasize memory, chant/singing, and regular review as memory-enhancing pedagogy (scholastic-like restful learning and memorization). - The Trivium-based approach is described for all subjects, with grammar/logic/rhetoric progression across grade levels; the public materials show a deliberate movement from foundational memory work to logic and rhetoric. - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetorical training (as part of the trivium progression toward rhetoric

and public speaking) and opportunities to give speeches. This is aligned with classical teaching methods. - The school highlights a “living curriculum” through its Portrait of a Graduate and alignment with classical teaching methods; The Four Foundations of Great Teaching materials guide teaching practice.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé/restful learning, singing/chanting, memory work, grammar/logic/reasoning, Socratic dialogue/seminars, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, living curriculum. - Negative keywords: none detected (no explicit emphasis on project-based or purely experiential learning as the sole method; classical methods predominate).

Why this rating - The pedagogy matches classical norms: a memory-based lower-school pedagogy (singing/chanting) and a logic/rhetoric-augmented upper-school pedagogy with Socratic/seminar-style inquiry and public-speaking opportunities. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The employment materials describe the faculty as experienced professionals who are passionate about their fields and committed to the education of students; they emphasize teacher mentorship and a strong faculty culture. - The Portrait of a Graduate and mission statements frame teachers as the living curriculum and as mentors, signaling a virtue-modeling, character-formation role. - There are explicit references to faculty development and ongoing professional growth in recruitment/outreach materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: experienced educators, mentors, living curriculum, teachers as centers of virtue and knowledge, professional growth, Christ-centered mission informing teaching. - Negative keywords: none evident in the public-facing materials; no language implying a weak or non-mentoring faculty culture.

Why this rating - The public materials present a strong, mission-driven, mentor-led faculty with a clearly articulated expectation of virtue and mastery, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and positions parents as co-teachers or partners in education; events and information nights are promoted to engage families. - The site highlights family resources, information nights, and opportunities for parental involvement and education about classical education (e.g., Great Books conversation, classical methods, and faith-based formation). □filecite□turn9file?□ - The school states explicit Christ-centered messaging and a community-focused mission; families are invited to learn and participate in campus life (open visits, events).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, family resources, information nights, welcoming families for visits, Christ-centered focus, involvement in education. - Negative keywords: none evident; no suggestions of distrust or separation from families.

Why this rating - The public materials depict strong parent/community engagement and transparency, consistent with classical education models that emphasize a shared home-school formation and parental partnership. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment - Category-by-category ratings: CLASSICAL across all six categories. - Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Not required for a CLASSICAL aggregate rating. No major needle-moving changes are necessary to be fully CLASSICAL. If desired, the school could consider enhancing explicit language around Socratic inquiry in the upper grades (if not already explicit on the site) to further strengthen the Pedagogy side and ensure every category has overt textual support for “Socratic/dialogue/seminars” in public-facing pages.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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